

Revelation 1

The Centrality of the Second Coming

Text Structure:

A	1	vss. 1-6	Christ and John (Bible & prophetic gift): Time is short (vss. 1-3)
	2		The Judgment: the 3 (vss. 4-6)
B			The Second Coming (vs. 7)
A'	1'	vss. 8-20	Christ and John (Bible & prophetic gift): Persecution (vss. 8-9)
	2'		The Judgment: Christ, Our Great High Priest (vss. 10-20)

vss. 1-3, 8-9—**John**: recall that John symbolizes the 144,000.

vss. 1-3, 8-9—**John and the Word of God and the Testimony of Jesus Christ**:

Revelation 1:1-2: ...John: ² Who bare record of the word of God, and of the testimony of Jesus Christ,...

Revelation 1:9: I John, who also am your brother, and companion in tribulation, ... was in the isle that is called Patmos, for the word of God, and for the testimony of Jesus Christ.

Revelation 19:10: ...the testimony of Jesus is the spirit of prophecy.

1 Corinthians 12:4-10, 28-30: ⁴ Now there are diversities of gifts, but the same Spirit. ... ⁸ For to one is given by the Spirit the word of wisdom; to another the word of knowledge by the same Spirit; ⁹ To another faith by the same Spirit; to another the gifts of healing by the same Spirit; ¹⁰ To another the working of miracles; to another prophecy; to another discerning of spirits; to another divers kinds of tongues; to another the interpretation of tongues: ... ²⁸ And God hath set some in the church, first apostles, secondarily prophets, thirdly teachers, after that miracles, then gifts of healings, helps, governments, diversities of tongues. ²⁹ Are all apostles? are all prophets? are all teachers? are all workers of miracles? ³⁰ Have all the gifts of healing? do all speak with tongues? do all interpret?

Ephesians 4:7-11: ⁷ But unto every one of us is given grace according to the measure of the gift of Christ. ⁸ Wherefore he saith, When he ascended up on high, he led captivity captive, and gave gifts unto men. ⁹ (Now that he ascended, what is it but that he also descended first into the lower parts of the earth? ¹⁰ He that descended is the same also that ascended up far above all heavens, that he might fill all things.) ¹¹ And he gave some, apostles; and some, prophets; and some, evangelists; and some, pastors and teachers;

John testifies of both the word of God and the spirit of prophecy (i.e., he is a prophet) and for both of these he undergoes persecution. Tradition says John was boiled in oil, in order to try to kill him. He ended up on Patmos because he could not be killed.

Acts 2:16-20: ¹⁶ But this is that which was spoken by the prophet Joel; ¹⁷ And it shall come to pass in the last days, saith God, I will pour out of my Spirit upon all flesh: and your sons and your daughters shall prophesy, and your young men shall see visions, and your old men shall dream dreams: ¹⁸ And on my servants and on my handmaidens I will pour out in those days of my Spirit; and they shall prophesy: ¹⁹ And I will shew wonders in heaven above, and signs in the earth beneath; blood, and fire, and vapour of smoke: ²⁰ The sun shall be turned into darkness, and the moon into blood, before that great and notable day of the Lord come:

vs. 6:12-13: ¹² And I beheld when he had opened the sixth seal, and, lo, there was a great earthquake; and the sun became black as sackcloth of hair, and the moon became as blood; ¹³ And the stars of heaven fell unto the earth, even as a fig tree casteth her untimely figs, when she is shaken of a mighty wind.

We are living in the time of the revival of the prophetic gift:

- 1) "a great earthquake": the Great Lisbon Earthquake of November 1, 1755;
- 2) "the sun became black...": the Dark Day of New England of May 19, 1780; and
- 3) "the stars of heaven fell": the meteor shower of November 12-13, 1833.

Notice that "...the spirits of the prophets are subject to the prophets (i.e. the Scriptures or word of God)."¹ (*1 Corinthians 14:32*) This is why John is said to testify both of the word of God and the testimony of Jesus Christ, for the words he prophesied were in agreement with God's word, the Scriptures.

vss. 4-6, 10-20—the Judgment: **A2** (vss. 4-6) parallels *Daniel 7:9-10, 13-14*, a picture of the Judgment while **A2'** (vss. 10-20) parallels *Daniel 10:5-6, 8-10*, a picture of Christ as our High priest dressed as on the Day of Atonement or Judgment.

Revelation 1:1-3

John, the Revelation of Jesus Christ (the Revealed Christ), and the Shortness of Time

Text Structure:

A	1	vss. 1-2	vs. 1a
	2		vs. 1b
	3		vs. 1c
	4		vs. 1d
	3'		vs. 1e
A'	2'		vs. 2a
	1'		vs. 2b
			vs. 3

Text:

¹ The Revelation of Jesus Christ

which **God** gave to him

to show **to his servants**

things which must **come to pass shortly**.

And he signified *it* by sending *it* by his angel **to his servant** John

² who testified of the word of **God**

and the testimony of **Jesus Christ** of all things that he saw.

³ Blessed is the *one* that readeth and the *ones* that hear the words of this prophecy and keep those *things* which are written in it for **the time is at hand**.

vss. 1,3—Blessed is the one to whom Christ is revealed:

Revelation 1:1,3; 22:7: ^{1:1} The Revelation of Jesus Christ... ³ Blessed is he that readeth, and they that hear the words of this prophecy, and keep those things which are written therein... ^{22:7} ...blessed is he that keepeth the sayings of the prophecy of this book.

This is the only book in the entire Bible that explicitly says there is a blessing for reading and keeping its contents. Of course, there is a blessing accompanied with the reading of all of God's word, but it is as if God wants us to especially take notice of this book. *Why would God put such emphasis on Revelation?* First and foremost, because it is the "Revelation of Jesus Christ..." The ultimate goal of prophecy is salvational! Prophecy was written to give us a clearer vision of Christ, clearer than any other picture in Scripture, so that through its study we might see Christ more clearly than ever before and be transformed into His likeness. *How do we know this is the ultimate goal?* Because the New Testament and *Revelation* make this obvious. Perhaps you do not understand. Keep reading. In the next two chapters it will be made clear. *But the "Revelation of Jesus Christ..." requires "the Testimony of Jesus Christ" or "the Spirit of Prophecy"?*

vs. 1—"which God gave to" Jesus Christ who "signified it": Prophecy is written in symbols so it must be deciphered. *How?* Prayer for the Holy Spirit and then searching the Scriptures for God says...

2 Peter 1:20-21: ²⁰ Knowing this first, that no prophecy of the scripture is of any private interpretation. ²¹ For the prophecy came not in old time by the will of man: but holy men of God spake as they were moved by the Holy Ghost.

Prophecy is not what you or I or the church say it is, but what God says it is. He speaks to us through His word so we must search for the answers in scripture.

vs. 1—John: John (as well as Daniel) is symbolic of God's last messengers to the world, the 144,000. *Revelation's*, as well as *Daniel's*, that is, prophecy's purpose is to prepare these messengers, not only by changing them but by also giving them a spiritual weapon, the prophecies of *Daniel* and *Revelation*, to wage war against Satan and bring an end to this sin sick world and enable Jesus to come back. *But, what about "the Spirit of Prophecy"?*

Revelation 1:1-2: ¹ ...John: ² Who bare record of the word of God, and of the testimony of Jesus Christ [the Spirit of Prophecy], and of all things that he saw.

Yes, to be a John requires not only the Word of God but the Spirit of Prophecy. You must become a prophet. Tough calling but God is able if we will but submit to Him and ask for it.

Luke 11:13: If ye then, being evil, know how to give good gifts unto your children: how much more shall your heavenly Father give the Holy Spirit to them that ask him?

Remember that this has been prophesied already.

Joel 2:28-29: ²⁸ And it shall come to pass afterward, that I will pour out my spirit upon all flesh; and your sons and your daughters shall prophesy, your old men shall dream dreams, your young men shall see visions: ²⁹ And also upon the servants and upon the handmaids in those days will I pour out my spirit.

vss. 1,3—“come to pass shortly” and “the time is at hand”: There is reason to awaken. God is urgent! Though there is no definite time to be set, yet the overall message of verses 1-3, that is contained in the structure of these verses, and the message God wishes to give to his people, “John,” the 144,000, is that time is short! Now is the time to put everything into reaching a world lost in sin. Seek out Christ, study God’s word, in particular prophecy, seek for the Holy Spirit, the latter rain, and ask to be transformed into the image of Christ. The world is lost in deception, thus prophecy, but they need to see God, love in action, Christ in us, thus we need transformation, plus, we need directions from Omniscience, thus the need of an unrestricted out pouring of the Holy Spirit. We have our work cut out. Let’s get to it.

Revelation 1:4-6

Message from The 3 in the Judgment

Text Structure of vss. 5b-6:

A	vs. 5b
B	vs. 5c
A’	vs. 5d
B’	vs. 6

Text:

⁴ John, to the seven churches, to them *which are* in Asia, Grace *be* unto you and peace from **[I]** (the *one*), (God), *him* who is and who was and who is to come and from

[II] the Seven Spirits/(*or* the Seven-fold Spirit) (of the *Godhead*) which are/(is) before his throne⁵ and from

[III] Jesus Christ

who is the faithful witness, even unto **death**^{*}, the first begotten of the **dead**, and the ruler of **the kings** of the earth.

Unto the *one* that loved us and freed us from our sins with his **blood**.

⁶ And hath made us **kings** and priests (a kingdom of priests,) (a residence for the King,) (a holy kingdom,) (a royal priesthood) unto (*and of*) God and his Father—to him be the glory and **the dominion** for ever and ever. Amen!

^{*}a “witness, even unto death” *or* a martyr *or* “one who dies for his witness”

vss. 4-6—the entire text: these verses make reference to *chapters 4 and 5*.

vss. 4-6	chs. 4 & 5
“him which is, and which was, and which is to come” [*] who sits upon a “throne” (vs. 4)	“a throne was set in heaven, and one sat on the throne.” (vs. 4:2)
“ the seven Spirits ” ^{**} which are before his throne” (vs. 4)	“seven lamps of fire burning before the throne, which are the seven Spirits ” ^{**} of God.” (vs. 4:5)
“Jesus Christ” ^{***} (vs. 5)	“a Lamb” ^{***} as it had been slain” (vs. 5:6)
“Unto him that loved us, and freed us from our sins with his own blood , And hath made us kings and priests unto God and his Father ; to him be glory and dominion for ever and ever. Amen.” (vss. 5-6)	“thou wast slain, and hast redeemed us to God with thy blood out of every kindred, and tongue, and people, and nation; And hast made us unto our God kings and priests : and we shall reign on the earth.” (vss. 5:9-10)

^{*} “him who is, and who was, and who is to come” is Yahweh (or however you wish to write and pronounce it), Jehovah, the I AM, him who’s nature is one who is ever existent, expressed in Greek as the one who fills past, present, and future.

^{**} As God is three fold, occupying past, present, and future, so the Holy Spirit is seven fold, in *the book of Revelation*, occupying the seven periods of the church, Ephesus through to Laodicea (*chs. 2 & 3*).

^{***} *John 1:29*: The next day John seeth Jesus coming unto him, and saith, Behold the Lamb of God, which taketh away the sin of the world.

There is only one other passage in the Bible that is similar to the picture given in *Revelation 4 and 5*, and thus *Revelation 1:4-6*, and that is, the Judgment scene of *Daniel 7*. Notice the similarities.

<i>Daniel 7:9-10,13-14</i>	<i>Revelation 1:4-6 & 4 & 5</i>
"the Ancient of days did sit" on a "throne" (vs. 9)	"him which is, and which was, and which is to come" who sits upon a "throne" (vs. 1:4)
"the thrones were cast down (set up)" (vs. 9)	"a throne was set in heaven" ... "And round about the throne were four and twenty seats" (vss. 4:2,4)
"A fiery stream issued and came forth from before him" (vs. 10)	"seven lamps of fire burning before the throne, which are the seven Spirits of God." (vs. 4:5)
"thousand thousands ministered unto him, and ten thousand times ten thousand stood before him" (vs. 10)	"many angels round about the throne ... and the number of them was ten thousand times ten thousand, and thousands of thousands;" (vs. 5:11)
"one like the Son of man"* (vs. 13) "And there was given him dominion, and glory, and a kingdom, that all people, nations, and languages, should serve him: his dominion is an everlasting dominion, which shall not pass away, and his kingdom that which shall not be destroyed." (vs. 14)	"Jesus Christ"* (vs. 1:5) "to him be glory and dominion for ever and ever." (vs. 1:6)

*Jesus often refers to himself as the "Son of man" in the gospels. See *Matt. 8:20; 9:6; 10:23; 11:19; 12:8, 32, 40; 13:37, 41; 16:13, 27; etc.*

One final point needs to be made. If *Revelation 1:4-6* (as well as *chapters 4 & 5*) is indeed a picture of the Judgment, as in *Daniel 7*, then the Second Coming should follow. This is exactly what is found following *verses 1:4-6*, in *verse 7*. The picture of the Second Coming, found in *verse 7*, displays one other link to *Daniel 7*'s Judgment. In *Daniel 7*, Jesus comes to the Father "with the clouds of heaven." In *Revelation 1:7*, he comes to earth "with clouds."

vs. 5—"the First Begotten of the Dead": this is the full expression of what is stated other wheres as "the first begotten of the Father." It is a reference to *Hebrews 1:5-6* but ultimately and originally to *Psalms 2*.

¹ Why do the heathen rage, and the people imagine a vain thing? ² The kings of the earth set themselves, and the rulers take counsel together, against the Lord, and against his anointed, saying, ³ Let us break their bands asunder, and cast away their cords from us. ⁴ He that sitteth in the heavens shall laugh: the Lord shall have them in derision. ⁵ Then shall he speak unto them in his wrath, and vex them in his sore displeasure. ⁶ Yet have I set my king upon my holy hill of Zion. ⁷ I will declare the decree: the Lord hath said unto me, **Thou art my Son; this day have I begotten thee.** ⁸ Ask of me, and I shall give thee the heathen for thine inheritance, and the uttermost parts of the earth for thy possession. ⁹ Thou shalt break them with a rod of iron; thou shalt dash them in pieces like a potter's vessel. ¹⁰ Be wise now therefore, O ye kings: be instructed, ye judges of the earth. ¹¹ Serve the Lord with fear, and rejoice with trembling. ¹² Kiss the Son, lest he be angry, and ye perish from the way, when his wrath is kindled but a little. Blessed are all they that put their trust in him.

An explanation of this *Psalms* can be found in *the book of Acts*.

vss 4:24-28: ²⁴ And when they heard that, they lifted up their voice to God with one accord, and said, Lord, thou art God, which hast made heaven, and earth, and the sea, and all that in them is: ²⁵ Who by the mouth of thy servant David hast said, Why did the heathen rage, and the people imagine vain things? ²⁶ The kings of the earth stood up, and the rulers were gathered together against the Lord, and against his Christ. ²⁷ For of a truth against thy holy child Jesus, whom thou hast anointed, both Herod, and Pontius Pilate, with the Gentiles, and the people of Israel, were gathered together, ²⁸ For to do whatsoever thy hand and thy counsel determined before to be done.

vs. 13:33: God hath fulfilled the same unto us their children, in that he hath raised up Jesus again; as it is also written in the second psalm, Thou art my Son, this day have I begotten thee.

From these two quotes in *Acts* it can be seen that *Psalms 2* talks of the trial (vss. 1-2) and resurrection of Christ (vs. 7). In *Psalms 2*, elaborated by *Acts 13:33* and *Hebrews 1:5-6*, is the only statement ever made by God, in the scriptures, of **WHEN** he begot Christ. There is not another reference in the entire Bible to when this occurred outside of this reference in *Psalms 2*. This ought to be of the greatest importance to a Bible believer and should take precedence above all other opinions concerning Christ's begotten nature.

The importance of *Psalms 2* in the understanding of *Revelation* is further emphasized by its repeated quoting of *verse 9*, "Thou shalt break them with a rod of iron; thou shalt dash them in pieces like a potter's vessel." This verse is quoted in part or in full in the following places in *Revelation*: vss. 2:27; 12:5; 19:15.

<i>Psalms 2</i>	Fulfillment
"Why do the heathen rage, and the people imagine a vain thing? The kings of the earth set themselves, and the rulers take counsel together, against the Lord, and against his anointed," (vss. 1-2)	The trial (<i>Acts 4:24-28</i>)
"Yet have I set my king upon my holy hill of Zion." (vs. 6)	The crucifixion

"I will declare the decree: the Lord hath said unto me, Thou art my Son; this day have I begotten thee." (vs. 7)	The resurrection (<i>Acts 13:33</i>)
"Thou shalt break them with a rod of iron; thou shalt dash them in pieces like a potter's vessel." (vs. 9)	The second coming (<i>Rev. 19:15</i>)

vs. 6—"kings and priests" vs. "a kingdom of priests":

Revelation 21:24: And the nations of them which are saved shall walk in the light of it: and **the kings of the earth** do bring their glory and honour into it.

1 Peter 2:9: But ye are a chosen generation, **a royal priesthood**, an holy nation, a peculiar people; that ye should shew forth the praises of him who hath called you out of darkness into his marvellous light:

Exodus 19:6: And ye shall be unto me **a kingdom of priests**, and an holy nation. These are the words which thou shalt speak unto the children of Israel.

Revelation 1:7

The Second Coming

Text:

⁷ Behold he cometh with the clouds and every eye shall see him and *they also* who pierced him and all the kindreds of the earth shall wail because of him. Even so, Amen!

vs. 7—"they also which pierced him": A reference to *Psalms 22*.

Psalms 16: For dogs have compassed me: the assembly of the wicked have inclosed me: they pierced my hands and my feet.

The dogs are symbolic of the Romans.

Revelation 1:8-9

John, Jesus Christ, and Persecution

Text Structure:

A	vs. 8a
B	vs. 8b
C	vs. 8c
D	vs. 9a
C'	vs. 9b
B'	vs. 9c
A'	vs. 9d

Text:

⁸ I am the Alpha and the Omega, the beginning and the ending,
(even) **saith*** the Lord **God**,
who is and who was and who is to come, the Almighty.

⁹ I John, (the *one who even is*) your brother and companion in the tribulation
and (in the) kingdom and patience (*that is*) in *and of*** **Jesus Christ**
was in the isle, the *one that is* called Patmos, for **the word*** of **God**
and (for) the testimony of **Jesus Christ**.

*"saith", λεγει vs. "word", λογος

****patience** that is in **Jesus Christ** and **patience** that is like the patience of **Jesus Christ**.

vss. 8-9—the structure: this structure establishes the divinity of Christ by applying to him the titles of “the Alpha and the Omega, the Beginning and the Ending”—the Old Testament/Hebrew title, “the First and the Last” (*Isaiah 41:4; 44:6; 48:12; 43:10*) combined with Christ, as the Word, Logos, for the New Testament Greek/gentile, universal church—and “who is and who was and who is to come, the Almighty”—a Greek rendition of Yahweh, “I AM”, combined with El Shaddai, God Almighty (*Genesis 17:1; 28:3; 35:11; 43:14; 48:3; 49:25; etc.*).

vs. 9—“companion in tribulation”: I think this is obvious. To be a John means conflict and perhaps torture and perhaps even attempted murder (actual death, if you only think you are a John, but are not one).

Revelation 1:10-20

John’s Vision of Christ

Text Structure:

A	1	vss. 10-13a	vss. 10-11a
	2		vs. 11b
	3		vss. 12-13a
B			vss. 13b-16
A’	1’	vss. 17-20	vss. 17-18
	2’		vs. 19
	3’		vs. 20

Text:

¹⁰ I was in *the* Spirit on the Lord’s Day and heard behind me a great voice as of a trumpet ¹¹ saying (unto me, John), I am the Alpha and the Omega, **the First and the Last** and what thou seest **write** in a book and send *it* unto the seven churches, (unto the *ones* in Asia,) unto Ephesus, and unto Smyrna, and unto Pergamos, and unto Thyatira, and unto Sardis, and unto Philadelphia, and unto Laodicea.

¹² And (there) I turned to see the voice that spake with me. And being turned I saw **seven lampstands of gold**. ¹³ And in *the* midst of **the seven lampstands** *one* like unto *the* Son of man clothed *with a garment down* to the foot and girt about, at the breast, in a girdle of gold. ¹⁴ Moreover his head and hairs *were* white, (even) as if wool, white as snow, and his eyes as a flame of fire. ¹⁵ And his feet like unto fine bronze as *if* burned in a furnace and his voice as *the* voice of many waters. ¹⁶ And he had in his right hand seven stars and out of his mouth went a sharp two-edged sword and his countenance was as the sun shinning in its full strength.

¹⁷ And when I saw him I fell at his feet as dead. And he laid his right hand upon me saying unto me, Fear not, I am **the First and the Last** ¹⁸ and the Living *One* and I was dead and, behold!, I am living for ever and ever, amen! and have the keys of death and of Hades.

¹⁹ **Write** therefore *the things* which thou hast seen and *the things* which are and *the things* which are about to be hereafter.

²⁰ The mystery of the seven stars which thou sawest upon my right hand and **the seven lampstands of gold**. The seven stars are *the* messengers of the seven churches and **the seven lampstands** (of gold) which thou sawest are the seven churches.

vs. 13—“(one) like unto the Son of man...”: the description here, of Christ, has its closest parallel in *Daniel 10*.

Daniel 10:5-6: ⁵ Then I lifted up mine eyes, and looked, and behold a certain man clothed in linen, whose loins were girded with fine gold of Uphaz: ⁶ His body also was like the beryl, and his face as the appearance of lightning, and his eyes as lamps of fire, and his arms and his feet like in colour to polished brass, and the voice of his words like the voice of a multitude.

Comparing the two description side by side, aspect by aspect, we find the following results.

Daniel 10:5-6, 9-10	Revelation 1:13-17
a certain man	...one like unto the Son of man,
clothed in linen,	clothed with a garment down to the foot,
whose loins were girded with fine gold of Uphaz:	and girt about the paps with a golden girdle.

His body also was like the beryl, No parallel!	No parallel! His head and his hairs were white like wool, as white as snow;
and his face as the appearance of lightning,	See below!
and his eyes as lamps of fire,	and his eyes were as a flame of fire;
and his arms and his feet like in colour to polished brass,	And his feet like unto fine brass, as if they burned in a furnace;
and the voice of his words like the voice of a multitude.	and his voice as the sound of many waters.
No parallel! No parallel!	And he had in his right hand seven stars: and out of his mouth went a sharp twoedged sword:
See above!	and his countenance was as the sun shineth in his strength.
...then was I in a deep sleep on my face, and my face toward the ground. And, behold, an hand touched me,...	...I fell at his feet as dead. And he laid his right hand upon me,...

The parallels between *Revelation 1* and *Daniel 10* are too many and yet there are little differences. *Why?*